

PROJECT DOCUMENTATION

Project Title

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Details

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 - **Semester:** 5
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1. ABSTRACT

The project “**Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer**” focuses on improving the IT procurement process by automating the ordering and configuration workflow for standard laptops.

The existing procurement process involves manual activities that can result in delays, increased manual effort, and inefficient resource allocation. In particular, standard laptop requests require configuration, but this step may be overlooked or delayed.

To address this issue, the project implements an automated workflow using **ServiceNow Flow Designer**. When a Standard Laptop request is submitted and approved, the workflow automatically creates a Catalog Task and assigns it to the **Hardware** assignment group for configuration.

This automation reduces manual intervention, helps ensure timely laptop configuration, reduces user waiting time, and improves the efficiency of the IT procurement process.

2. INTRODUCTION

IT departments handle various requests from users, including hardware procurement and laptop requests. A standard laptop request may require additional configuration before it can be delivered to the user.

When these activities are handled manually, there is a possibility of delays, missed configuration tasks, and inefficient allocation of IT resources.

This project introduces an automated workflow in ServiceNow using **Flow Designer**. The workflow is designed to automatically generate a Catalog Task after the service request receives approval and assign the task to the Hardware team.

The automated process provides a structured workflow from laptop request submission through approval and hardware configuration.

3. PROBLEM STATEMENT

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, resulting in delays and manual overhead, particularly when handling standard laptop orders.

Standard laptop requests often require configuration. However, the configuration step may be overlooked or delayed. This can cause frustration for users and lead to inefficient resource allocation within the IT department.

Therefore, an automated workflow is required to ensure that the required configuration task is generated and assigned to the appropriate Hardware team after approval.

4. USER STORY

As a member of the IT procurement team, I want a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the Hardware team for configuration.

This ensures that laptops can be configured promptly after arrival, reducing user waiting time and minimizing manual intervention.

5. PROJECT OBJECTIVES

The main objective is to implement an automated workflow using Flow Designer to facilitate the procurement and configuration of standard laptops.

The project objectives are:

1. To create a seamless experience for users requesting standard laptops.
 2. To ensure timely laptop configuration.
 3. To reduce manual intervention in the procurement process.
 4. To reduce potential errors.
 5. To improve resource utilization within the IT department.
 6. To optimize task allocation.
 7. To improve overall efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.
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6. PROJECT SCOPE

The project focuses on automating the workflow associated with **Standard Laptop** requests in ServiceNow.

The scope includes:

- Creating a Flow using Flow Designer.
 - Configuring a Service Catalog trigger.
 - Creating a Catalog Task automatically.
 - Setting the Catalog Task short description.
 - Setting the Catalog Task description.
 - Assigning the task to the Hardware group.
 - Configuring the approval condition.
 - Assigning the Flow to the Standard Laptop Service Catalog item.
 - Placing a Standard Laptop request.
 - Approving the request.
 - Verifying the generated Catalog Task.
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7. TECHNOLOGIES AND TOOLS USED

7.1 ServiceNow

ServiceNow is the main platform used to implement the IT procurement workflow.

7.2 Flow Designer

Flow Designer is used to create and automate the workflow for Standard Laptop requests.

The project creates a Flow named “**Standard Laptop Task**” with the application set to **Global** and the Run As option set to **System User**.

7.3 Service Catalog

The Service Catalog is used to provide the Standard Laptop request option to users.

7.4 Catalog Task

The Catalog Task is automatically created by the Flow and assigned to the Hardware group for laptop configuration.

8. SYSTEM REQUIREMENTS

The project requires access to a ServiceNow environment with the required modules and permissions.

Software Requirements

- ServiceNow instance
- Flow Designer
- Service Catalog
- Maintain Items
- Hardware Service Catalog
- Catalog Task functionality

User Requirements

The user should be able to:

- Access the Service Catalog.
- Select Standard Laptop.

- Place an order.
- View the request status.

IT Team Requirements

The IT procurement or Hardware team should be able to:

- Receive the automatically generated task.
 - View the task details.
 - Configure the laptop.
 - Track the status of the Catalog Task.
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9. SYSTEM DESIGN

The system is designed around an automated ServiceNow workflow.

Basic Workflow

Standard Laptop Request

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Service Catalog Trigger

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Approval

↓

Create Catalog Task

↓

Assign to Hardware

↓

Laptop Configuration

The Flow Designer automation connects the Service Catalog request with the Catalog Task required for hardware configuration.

10. FLOW DESIGN

A Flow named “**Standard Laptop Task**” is created in Flow Designer.

Flow Properties

- **Flow Name:** Standard Laptop Task
- **Application:** Global
- **Run As:** System User

After configuring the properties, the Flow is submitted.

11. FLOW TRIGGER

The Flow uses the **Service Catalog** trigger.

Steps

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Open **All**.
3. Search for **Flow Designer**.
4. Open Flow Designer under Process Automation.
5. Create a new Flow.
6. Click **Add a Trigger**.
7. Search for **Service Catalog**.
8. Select the Service Catalog trigger.
9. Click **Done**.

The Service Catalog trigger starts the workflow based on the catalog request.

12. CREATE CATALOG TASK ACTION

After configuring the trigger, an action is added to create the Catalog Task.

Configuration

1. Under **Actions**, click **Add an Action**.
2. Search for **Create Catalog Task**.
3. Select **Create Catalog Task**.
4. Use the **Requested Item Record** in the Request Item field.

5. The table is automatically populated as **Catalog Task**.
 6. Set the Short Description to:
“Laptop need to Configured”
 7. Add the Description field with the same value:
“Laptop need to Configured”
 8. Set the Assignment Group to:
Hardware
 9. Set the Approval field to:
Approved
 10. Leave the remaining fields at their default values.
 11. Click **Done**.
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13. SAVE AND ACTIVATE THE FLOW

After completing the Flow configuration:

1. Click **Save**.
2. Click **Activate**.
3. Click **Activate** again when required.

The Flow must be activated so that the automated workflow can operate for the Standard Laptop service request.

14. FLOW ASSIGNMENT

The created Flow must be associated with the Standard Laptop Service Catalog item.

Steps

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click **All**.
3. Search for **Maintain Items**.
4. Open Maintain Items.
5. Search for **Standard Laptop** under the Name field.

6. Select the Standard Laptop record.
7. Open **Process Engine**.
8. Remove the remaining automations.
9. Add **Flow**.
10. Select the Flow named:

“Standard Laptop Task”

11. Save the record.
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15. SERVICE CATALOG

After assigning the Flow, the Standard Laptop item can be accessed through the Service Catalog.

Steps

1. Open **All**.
 2. Search for **Service Catalog**.
 3. Open Service Catalog.
 4. Select **Hardware**.
 5. Find **Standard Laptop**.
 6. Click **Standard Laptop**.
 7. Click **Order Now** to place the request.
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16. REQUEST STATUS

After placing the Standard Laptop order, the request status can be viewed.

Steps

1. View the Order Status.
2. Click the **Request Number**.
3. The Requested Number record opens.
4. Scroll down to the **Approvers** section.

This allows the request approval information to be accessed.

17. REQUEST APPROVAL

The request must be approved before the configured Catalog Task can proceed.

Steps

1. Open the Approvers section.
 2. Right-click the record to view the configuration options.
 3. Select **Approve**.
 4. Open the **Requested Item** section.
 5. Open the Requested Item record.
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18. CATALOG TASK VERIFICATION

After approval, the automatically generated Catalog Task can be verified.

Steps

1. Open the Requested Item record.
2. Scroll down to the **Catalog Tasks** section.
3. Open the Catalog Task record.
4. Check the updated status.
5. Verify the Short Description.
6. Verify the Assigned Group.

The resulting Catalog Task contains the configured information and is assigned to the Hardware group.

19. WORKFLOW PROCESS

The complete workflow can be represented as follows:

User

↓

Service Catalog

↓

Standard Laptop

↓

Order Now

↓

Request Created

↓

Approval

↓

Approved

↓

Flow Designer

↓

Create Catalog Task

↓

Assignment Group: Hardware

↓

Laptop Configuration

This automated sequence reduces the need for manual task creation and helps ensure that the configuration activity is initiated after approval.

20. TESTING

The workflow can be verified by performing a Standard Laptop request through the Service Catalog.

Test Process

1. Open the Standard Laptop Service Catalog item.
2. Place an order.
3. Check the request status.
4. Open the Request Number.
5. Verify the Approvers section.

6. Approve the request.
7. Open the Requested Item.
8. Navigate to Catalog Tasks.
9. Open the generated Catalog Task.
10. Verify:
 - Task status
 - Short Description
 - Assignment Group

The project documentation specifically identifies the Catalog Task record as the point where the updated status, short description, and assigned group can be checked.

21. EXPECTED RESULT

The expected result of the project is an automated Standard Laptop procurement workflow.

After the request is approved, the system creates the required Catalog Task and assigns it to the Hardware team.

The expected benefits are:

- Faster task creation.
- Reduced manual intervention.
- Timely laptop configuration.
- Reduced user waiting time.
- Better task allocation.
- Improved IT procurement efficiency.
- Improved user experience.

These outcomes are consistent with the project's stated objectives and conclusion.

22. BENEFITS OF THE PROJECT

22.1 Reduced Manual Work

The workflow automatically creates the Catalog Task after approval, reducing the need for manual task creation.

22.2 Faster Configuration

The Hardware team receives the task through the automated process, helping ensure timely configuration.

22.3 Improved Resource Allocation

Tasks are automatically assigned to the Hardware group, supporting better utilization of IT resources.

22.4 Reduced User Waiting Time

The automated workflow helps minimize delays between approval and laptop configuration.

22.5 Improved Productivity

Automation reduces manual overhead and improves the efficiency of IT procurement operations.

23. LIMITATIONS

Based strictly on the provided project document, the implementation is focused on the **Standard Laptop** procurement workflow and its associated Catalog Task.

The source document does not provide detailed information about:

- Multiple laptop models.
- Inventory management.
- Cost calculation.
- Vendor management.
- Email notifications.
- Reporting dashboards.
- Advanced security controls.

Therefore, these areas are not included as implemented features of the current project.

24. FUTURE ENHANCEMENTS

The current project can potentially be extended with additional procurement automation features, such as:

1. Automated notifications to users.
2. Additional hardware request categories.
3. Inventory availability checking.
4. Procurement tracking.
5. Automated status notifications.
6. Reporting and dashboard features.
7. Integration with other IT procurement processes.

These are possible extensions and are not described as implemented features in the supplied PDF.

25. PROJECT OUTCOME

The project successfully demonstrates an automated workflow for Standard Laptop procurement using ServiceNow Flow Designer.

The workflow connects the Service Catalog request with approval and automatic Catalog Task creation. The Catalog Task is configured with the required description and assigned to the Hardware group.

This creates a structured process for moving a Standard Laptop request from ordering and approval to hardware configuration.

26. CONCLUSION

The **“Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer”** project addresses inefficiencies and manual overhead in the Standard Laptop procurement process by implementing an automated workflow using ServiceNow Flow Designer.

The workflow ensures that, after approval, a Catalog Task is automatically created and assigned to the Hardware team for configuration. This helps provide timely laptop configuration, minimize user waiting time, improve resource allocation, and enhance productivity within the IT department.

The implementation therefore provides a streamlined and efficient approach to Standard Laptop procurement through ServiceNow automation.

27. WORKFLOW SUMMARY

Stage	Process
1	User selects Standard Laptop
2	User places the order
3	Service Catalog request is created
4	Request goes for approval
5	Request is approved
6	Flow Designer workflow runs
7	Catalog Task is created
8	Short Description is updated
9	Assignment Group is set to Hardware
10	Hardware team receives the task
11	Laptop configuration can proceed

Final Workflow

Standard Laptop → Order → Approval → Flow Designer → Create Catalog Task → Hardware Assignment → Configuration

28. FINAL PROJECT RESULT

The final implementation provides an automated ServiceNow workflow for Standard Laptop requests. The system reduces manual intervention by automatically creating and assigning the required Catalog Task after approval.

The project demonstrates how Flow Designer can be used to streamline IT procurement operations and support a more efficient process for standard laptop configuration.